

Sprint 4 — Builder Pattern

Learning Goals

After this sprint, we should be able to:

- Understand why Builder exists.
- Identify the "Telescoping Constructor" problem.
- Compare Constructor vs Setter vs Builder.
- Build immutable objects.
- Use Builder in Java.
- Use Lombok Builder.
- Understand Builder in Spring Boot.
- Know when **NOT** to use Builder.

Class 1

Instead of immediately showing Builder code, we first create the pain.

Lesson 1 — Why Builder Exists

Learning Objective

By the end of this lesson we should be able to answer:

- Why constructors become difficult.
- Why setters are not always good.
- What Builder solves.
- When Builder should be used.

Real Enterprise Example

Imagine we are developing Room Platform.

A room contains:

id
propertyId
roomCode
roomName
roomType
maxAdult
maxChild
price
currency
area
floor
bedType
wifi
parking
kitchen
balcony
airConditioner
television
description
status

Almost 20 fields.

How should we create it?

Option 1

Huge Constructor

```
Room room = new Room(  
    id,  
    propertyId,  
    roomCode,  
    roomName,  
    roomType,
```

```
    maxAdult,  
    maxChild,  
    area,  
    floor,  
    bedType,  
    price,  
    currency,  
    hasWifi,  
    hasKitchen,  
    hasParking,  
    hasBalcony,  
    hasAirConditioner,  
    hasTelevision,  
    description,  
    status  
);
```

Can you remember which parameter is number 11?

Problems

Very difficult to read.

Easy to swap parameters.

Compile successfully.

Wrong business data.

Example

```
new Room(  
    ...  
    2,  
    5  
);
```

Is

2 adults
5 children

or

5 adults
2 children

Nobody knows.

Real Bug

This happens in enterprise projects.

```
new User(  
    firstName,  
    lastName,  
    email,  
    phone,  
    address,  
    role,  
    status,  
    gender  
);
```

Someone accidentally swaps:

status
gender

The compiler says: OK

Business says: Wrong data.

Why Constructors Become Bad

As the object grows:

3 fields -> 6 fields ->10 fields ->18 fields ->25 fields

Constructors become impossible to understand.

Lesson 2

Telescoping Constructor Pattern

Suppose only roomCode is required.

Tomorrow

Business adds

price

Then

currency

Then

wifi

Developers often do this.

```
public Room(String roomCode)
```

```
public Room(
```

```
String roomCode,  
BigDecimal price)
```

```
public Room(  
    String roomCode,  
    BigDecimal price,  
    Currency currency)
```

```
public Room(  
    String roomCode,  
    BigDecimal price,  
    Currency currency,  
    boolean wifi)
```

```
public Room(...)
```

This is called

Telescoping Constructor

Why It Is Bad

Too many constructors.

Hard to maintain.

Hard to remember.

Impossible after 15 fields.

Question

Have you ever seen a class with 10 constructors?

Usually no.

Lesson 3

JavaBeans Pattern (Setter Pattern)

Most developers improve constructors like this.

```
Room room = new Room();  
  
room.setRoomCode("DLX001");  
room.setRoomName("Deluxe");  
room.setPrice(BigDecimal.valueOf(50));  
room.setWifi(true);  
room.setKitchen(false);
```

Looks much cleaner.

Advantages

Readable.

Easy to understand.

Order doesn't matter.

But....

What if someone forgets

```
room.setPrice(...)
```

Now we have

Room

without price

Invalid object.

Another problem.

Someone can change later.

```
room.setPrice(null);
```

Oops.

Builder exists to solve this.

Lesson 4

Classic Builder Pattern

Step 1

Private constructor.

```
public class Room {  
  
    private String roomCode;  
    private String roomName;  
    private BigDecimal price;  
  
    private Room() {  
  
    }  
}
```

Nobody can


```
new Room();
```

Step 2

Builder

```
public static class Builder {  
  
    private final Room room = new Room();  
  
    public Builder roomCode(String roomCode) {  
        room.roomCode = roomCode;  
        return this;  
    }  
  
    public Builder roomName(String roomName) {  
        room.roomName = roomName;  
        return this;  
    }  
  
    public Builder price(BigDecimal price) {  
        room.price = price;  
        return this;  
    }  
  
    public Room build() {  
        return room;  
    }  
  
}
```

Usage

```
Room room = new Room.Builder()
```

```
.roomCode("DLX001")  
.roomName("Deluxe")  
.price(BigDecimal.valueOf(50))  
.build();
```

This is much easier to read.

Why It Is Better

Self-documenting.

No parameter order.

Easy to add fields.

Readable.

Lesson 5

Fluent Interface

Builder is actually a Fluent API.

Because every method returns Builder instead of void

Example

```
builder  
    .roomCode("DLX001")  
    .roomName("Deluxe")  
    .price(...)
```

Chain.

Other Fluent APIs we already know

```
Stream.of(...)
    .filter(...)
    .map(...)
    .collect(...)
```

StringBuilder

```
new StringBuilder()
    .append("Hello")
    .append(" Builder")
    .append(" Pattern");
```

Another Fluent API.

End of Class 1

We now understand

Constructors

Setters

Builder

Homework

Current code

```
User user = new User(
    id,
    firstName,
    lastName,
    phone,
    email,
    gender,
```

```
        birthday,  
        address,  
        active,  
        role  
    );
```

Tasks

Convert to Builder Pattern.

Add

```
department  
photo  
language  
country
```

without changing existing client code.

Class 1 Summary

Topic	We Learn
Why Builder Exists	The problem of complex object construction
Telescoping Constructor	Why many constructors become unmaintainable
JavaBeans Pattern	Advantages and weaknesses of setters
Classic Builder	Step-by-step implementation of the GoF Builder
Fluent Interface	Why method chaining makes Builder expressive